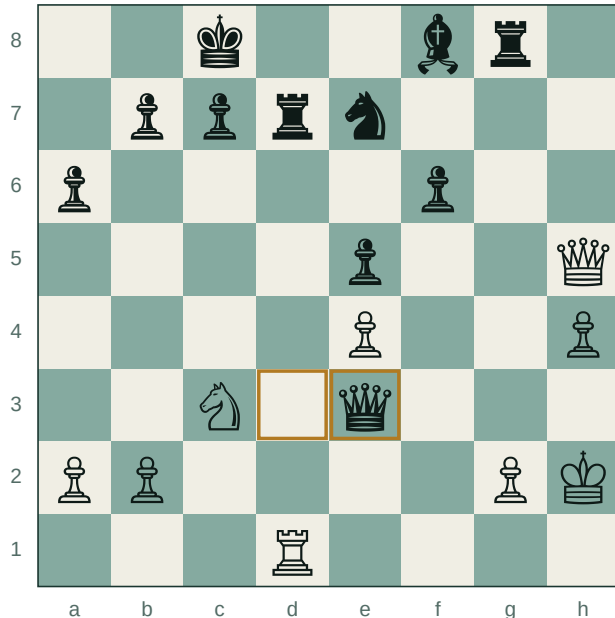


# Mate in two: White, move 23

Mate in two

## White to move



Previous move: 22...Qxe3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

## WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

### 23. Qe8+ Rd8 24. Rxd8#

**23.Qe8+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From e8 it attacks king on c8, rook on d7 and knight on e7.  
Recorded reply: **23...Rd8**.

**24.Rxd8#** Mate: rook on d8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on c8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

## CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on d8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

## CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The displayed line is one recorded defense. Test other legal replies instead of assuming the defender must copy it.

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A mating combination must survive the defender's reply. The first move should force a position in which a second move ends the game against every defense.

## HOW TO LOOK

Identify the likely mating square and the defender that prevents it. Calculate the forcing move that removes that resource.

The defending king is on c8. Geometrically undefended: queen on e3. Check for tactical protection.